

Moonsea Rising - 20231230

Aboard the Vile Flame

The party is escorted into a room where Edric and a Red Wizard are having tea. Edric excitedly introduces them to Laronen. The wizard sighs and puts down his tea, as a feeling of powerful magicks washes across the party. Edric flashes briefly with a purple aura, easy to miss. Edric begins cold-reading the party members. Lirael claims to be a Stardancer, from beyond Mulmaster, but Edric buys it not a little.

Laronen sarcastically suggests they raid Brulehaven and rescue the scions of the major houses. Edric jumps on the idea and is ready to go. Laronen begins providing them some of the intel Edric has gathered, including a purple-robed wizard named Montravious and a viscious pet dog who guards the man himself.

Harken, Edric, Laronen, and Beitris begin pitching around ideas for a distraction, from riots to arson to exposing gay lovers or creating the illusion of the Brule scion about in the city. Lirael suggests that perhaps Lady Talianos might take several Silverswords and demand entry to Brulehaven to search for the scions. Admitted or not, this has the potential to be a sufficient distraction for the infiltration. Laronen is a big fan of this surgical idea, and Edric thinks it better they not burn Melvaunt to the ground.

They concoct a plan for Jessica to take some pirates disguised as Silverswords and call on multiple houses before Brulehaven. Edric suggests Norster and Marsk would be amenable to assisting here.

Breaking the Bruleicos

As Jessica and the "Silverswords" announce their presence at the front gate, Edric and the party come to the northwest corner. There's a small building that acts as a sally port. Lirael approaches the single guard as the rest move off the deal with Jessica, and asks him about the house, claiming to be touring historic architecture, and casting charm. The guard resists, and tells Lirael to move on. As she moves off to the south, the party tries to stealthily circle around him to the north, but he spots them immediately. Taevyn says they're with Lirael for the tour, but the guard nervously reaches for his whistle.

Harken reaches out the man's mind and yells, "watch out for that knife behind your back!" The guard twitches slightly, half turning his head as Taevyn races in, slapping the whistle to the ground with his rapier. Lennox rushes forward, delivering two massive overhand blows with his axe, leaving the guard bloody and near death. Lirael races up, swinging her staff at the man to attempt to knock him out, catching him sharply across the temple. The man falls to the ground, unconscious. Taevyn quickly turns out his pockets and finds a ring of keys, as Lirael listens at the door to the building. A gruff male voice is apparently singing inside the building.

With nowhere to stash the body, Lirael suggests they tell the man in the building that the Silver-swords attacked the guard. Opening the door they find a second guard enjoying a meal, out of armor. He immediately panics and starts backing away, as Harken tries to convince him someone else attacked Bobby (the guard). He doesn't buy it, and makes to leave as Lennox and Taevyn rush after him.

Lennox vaults the table and gets there first, delivering a crushing blow from the side of the axe, knocking the man aside. Taevyn dances across the table tops, flipping behind the unarmed man with his rapier in hand. He whips the thin sword across the man, and reaches out to grab him. Harken strides up to the man and tells him, "stay down if you want to live." The guard is terrified and curls up on the floor. Taevyn asks him where the prisoners are, including Argens Brule. The guard is convinced that he's been kidnapped with the other scions. Taevyn is skeptical, and he asks where such a captive would be held, if they were here. The guard is certain the Bruleicos would never do such a thing. As Harken is binding him, he loses consciousness.

Lirael is concerned that this is going poorly. Lennox and Taevyn are surprised she thinks so, and Harken classes their infiltration so far as "undetected and unharmed". They move to the only door, which opens into the main courtyard of the compound. Harken peeks out the door, and notes that the described building with the cells, a squat, unlovely building, lies directly to the east. As the only visible guard moves off on his circuit, the party rushes to the cellblock. They find the door locked, but one of the keys on Taevyn's ring unlocks it. Looking at the rest of them, he shrugs meaningfully to the door. He pushes it open, and they find a cell with three beds and no prisoners. They pile in and close the door, as the guard wanders past again outside.

Once he passes, they open the inside door, and move into the interior hallway. They find a cage, which Taevyn unlocks. It contains an unknown prisoner who identifies himself as Tarrien Ilgata. He claims, rather convincingly, that he knows where the scions are, and can help them, as well as paying a 1000gp ransom if they release him. Beitris is skeptical, and tells Taevyn they'll return for him if his info is good.

Waiting for the guard to pass, they move to the next block. A loud clanking of chains and grunting noises come from behind the door. Lirael thinks it might be a large humanoid type, potentially even a giant. She counsels against unsecuring the door, as Lennox and Taevyn try and decide if they should do so. The next door sounds like it has a small crowd of men dining in a mess behind it, and the door beyond that as what sounds like two guards debating if there really is an army of orcs poised to attack the city. Running out of time on the guard patrol, Taevyn unlocks the door and they rush in.